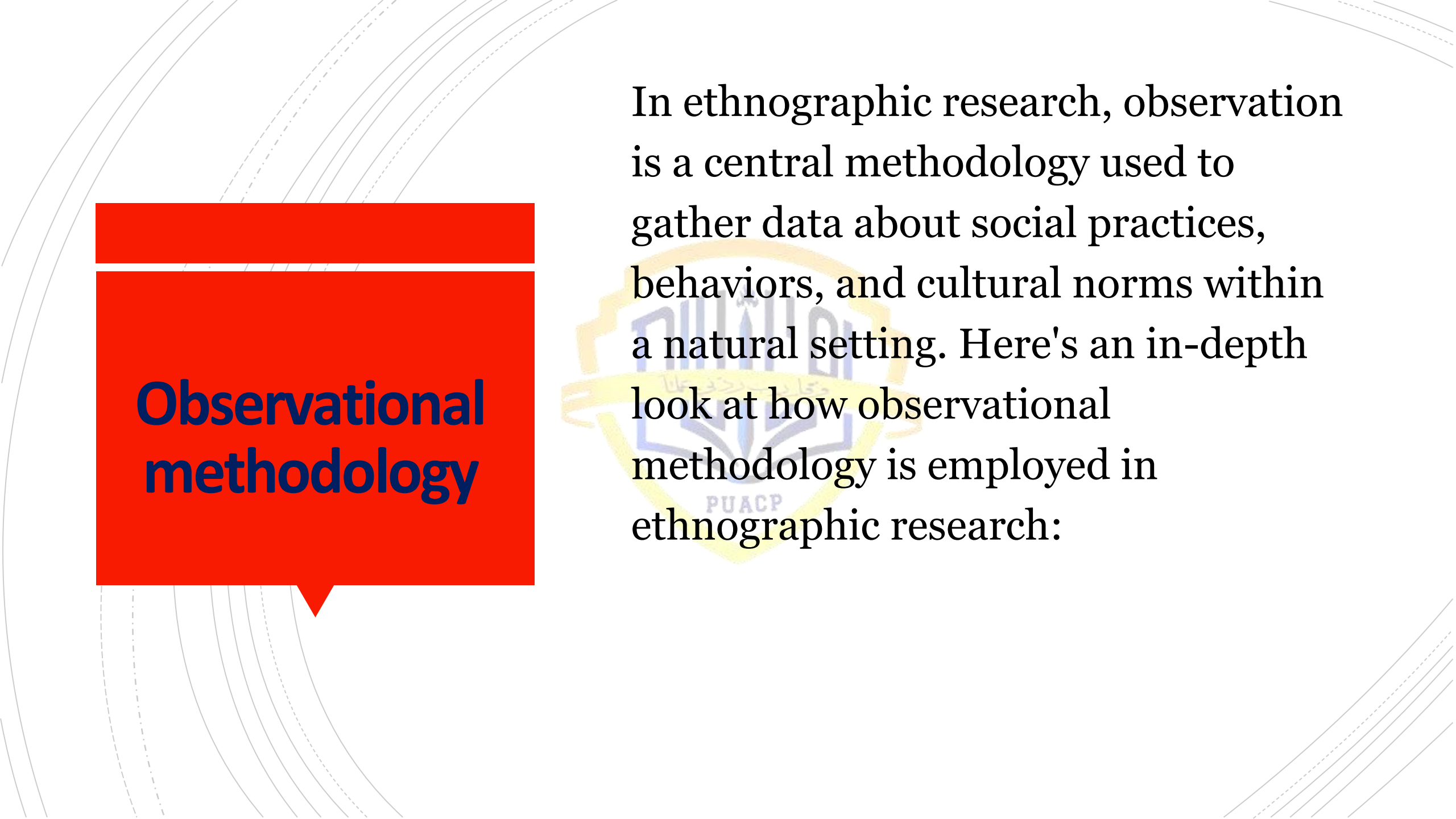


Observational methodology

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Researchmethods

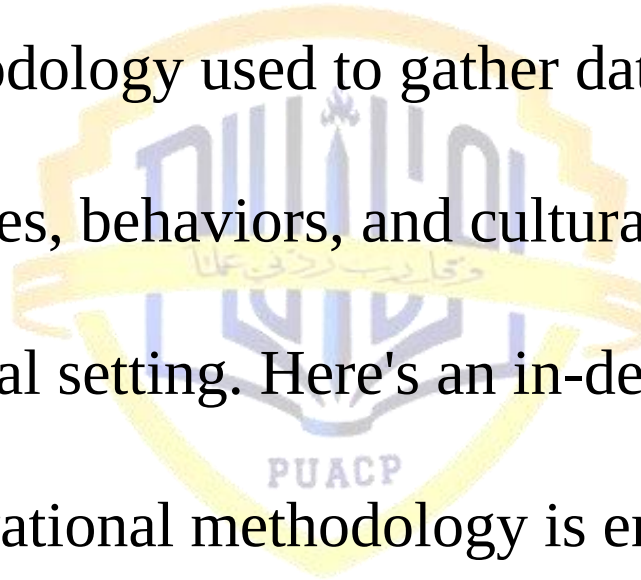


Observational methodology

In ethnographic research, observation is a central methodology used to gather data about social practices, behaviors, and cultural norms within a natural setting. Here's an in-depth look at how observational methodology is employed in ethnographic research:

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1. Types of Observation

❑ Participant Observation

The researcher becomes actively involved in the daily life of the study group while also observing their activities. This dual role allows for a deeper understanding of the participants' perspectives.

Forms:

Complete Participation

Participant as Observer

Observer as Participant

Complete Observer

❑ Non-participant Observation

The researcher observes without becoming involved in the group's activities. This can be done from a distance or in a more passive manner, aiming to minimize the researcher's influence on the participants' behavior.

Hira Satti

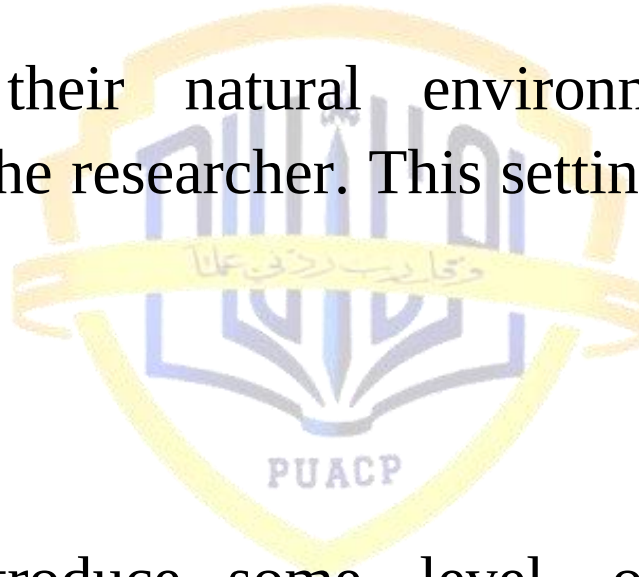
2. Observation Settings

☐ Naturalistic Observation

Observing people in their natural environment without any manipulation or control by the researcher. This setting helps in capturing authentic behavior.

☐ Controlled Observation

The researcher may introduce some level of control over the environment or setting to focus on specific behaviors or interactions, though this is less common in ethnography.



3. Data Collection Techniques

❑ **Field Notes**

Detailed, systematic records of observations. Field notes capture what the researcher sees, hears, and experiences, including descriptions of interactions, settings, and behaviors.

Types:

Descriptive Notes

Analytical Notes

Personal Notes

❑ **Audio/Video Recording**

Recording interactions and events to provide a more accurate and detailed account of the observed behaviors. This can be especially useful for capturing nuances and reviewing data.

4. Ethical Considerations

☐ Informed Consent

Participants should be fully informed about the research and provide their consent, particularly in overt observation. Even in covert observation, ethical considerations regarding privacy and deception must be addressed.

☐ Confidentiality

Protecting the identities of participants and ensuring that any data shared does not reveal personal information.

☐ Respect and Sensitivity

Being mindful of cultural norms, respecting participants' privacy, and considering the impact of the research on the community.

5. Data Analysis

❑ Coding and Categorization

Systematically organizing and interpreting the data from field notes and recordings. This involves identifying themes, patterns, and categories relevant to the research questions.

❑ Thematic Analysis

Analyzing data to identify and interpret recurring themes and significant patterns. This helps in understanding the broader meanings and implications of the observed behaviors.

❓ **Comparative Analysis**

Comparing observations across different contexts, settings, or groups to identify similarities and differences.

6. Reflexivity

Reflecting on how the researcher's background, perspective, and presence influence the research process and findings. This involves being aware of personal biases and the impact of the researcher's interactions with participants.

Application: Reflexivity helps in critically assessing how the researcher's role affects data collection and interpretation,

ensuring a more balanced and self-aware approach to the research.

7. Reporting Findings

☐ Descriptive Accounts

Providing detailed descriptions of the observed behaviors, settings, and interactions. This includes capturing the context and significance of the findings.

☐ Analytical Insights

Offering interpretations and analyses based on the observed data, linking observations to broader social or cultural theories.

❓ Narrative Construction

Crafting a narrative that weaves together observations into a coherent story or argument, providing a holistic understanding of the research findings.



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Thankyou
Anyquestion?